

Saniat Javid Sohrawardi (John)

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Research Interests Deepfake Detection, Digital Media Forensics, Human-Computer Interaction (HCI), Gamification & Game-based Learning, Usable Security, Responsible AI, and AI Ethics.

Education

- 2018 – Present** **Rochester Institute of Technology** – Rochester, NY
Ph.D. in Computing and Information Sciences
Advisor: Matthew K. Wright. *GPA:* 3.78.
- 2009 – 2013** **North South University** – Dhaka, Bangladesh
BSc. in Computer Science & Engineering
Minor: Molecular Genetics. *GPA:* 3.65.

Publications

- 2025** **Understanding and Empowering Intelligence Analysts: User-Centered Design for Deepfake Detection Tools**
Y.K. Wu, S.J. Sohrawardi, C.R. Gerstner, M. Wright.
ACM Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
- 2024** **Dungeons & Deepfakes: Using scenario-based role-play to study journalists' behavior towards using AI-based verification tools for video content**
S.J. Sohrawardi, Y. K. Wu, A. Hickerson, M. Wright.
ACM Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
- 2024** **A First Look into Targeted Clickbait and its Countermeasures: The Power of Storytelling**
A. Shrestha, A. Flood, S.J. Sohrawardi, M. N. Al-Ameen, M. Wright.
ACM Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
- 2020** **Recurrent Convolutional Structures for Audio Spoof and Video Deepfake Detection**
A. Chintha, B. Thai, S.J. Sohrawardi, K. Bhatt, A. Hickerson, M. Wright.
IEEE Journal of Selected Topics in Signal Processing.
- 2020** **Leveraging Edges and Optical Flow on Faces for Deepfake Detection**
A. Chintha, A. Rao, S.J. Sohrawardi, K. Bhatt, M. Wright, R. Ptucha.
IEEE International Joint Conference on Biometrics.
- 2020, 2021** **DeFaking Deepfakes: Understanding Journalists' Needs for Deepfake Detection**
S.J. Sohrawardi, S. Seng, A. Chintha, B. Thai, A. Hickerson, R. Ptucha, M. Wright.
Proceedings of the Computation + Journalism, Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security.
- 2019** **Towards Robust Open-World Detection of Deepfakes**
S.J. Sohrawardi, S. Seng, A. Chintha, S. Seng, B. Thai, A. Hickerson, R. Ptucha, M. Wright.
SIGSAC Conference on Computer and Communications Security.
- 2014** **A Comparative study of Text Classification Algorithms of User Submitted Bug Reports**
S.J. Sohrawardi, I. Azam, S. Hosain.
International Conference on Digital Information Management.
- 2013** **Bibliomining North South University Library Data**
I. Azam, S.J. Sohrawardi, H.S. Das, M.S. Alam, M.S. Alvy, R.M. Rahman.
International Conference on Digital Information Management.

Awards

- 2022 **Winner in the Oral Presentation Category**
RIT Graduate Showcase 2022 for "Dungeons & Deepfakes: A Role-Play Study to Understand Journalists' Usage of AI-based Video Verification Tools"

Experience

- Aug 2018 – Present** **Research Assistant**
Rochester Institute of Technology – Rochester, NY
DeFake Project: Developing deepfake detection tools and methods for journalists and intelligence analysts. Details can be found at <https://defake.app/about/>.
BaitBuster 2.0: Developing novel techniques to detect clickbait and study user behavior. More info at <https://www.preventclickbait.net/>.
- Aug 2017 – Aug 2018** **Senior Web Developer**
Boomerang Digital – Dhaka, Bangladesh
- Aug 2016 – June 2017** **Software Engineer**
Chaldal Limited – Dhaka, Bangladesh
- Feb 2015 – Aug 2016** **Senior Developer & Designer**
Boomerang Digital – Dhaka, Bangladesh
- May 2013 – Jan 2015** **Web Developer**
TXProIT – Dhaka, Bangladesh
- 2011 – 2018** **Director of Product Design**
ABSON DIGITECH – Dhaka, Bangladesh

Teaching & Mentorship

- Jan 2025 – May 2025** **Lecturer - CSEC 520/620 - Cyberanalytics & AI**
Rochester Institute of Technology – Rochester, NY
- 2023 – 2024** **Capstone Mentorship**
Mentored a total of seven students on three distinct capstone projects focused on deepfake detection and analysis.

Talks, Seminars, and Workshops

- 2025 DeFake Project Interview, *CNET*
- 2024 Introduction to AI - Media Manipulation and Deepfakes, *Michigan State University - CSE 440*
- DeFake Project Overview, *ClaimBuster Ideation Workshop*
- Deepfakes Demystified: Empowering Law Enforcement in the Digital Age Workshop, *Law Enforcement & Emergency Services Video Association International Inc. (LEVA)*
- Digital Media Forensics Ontology, *Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA)*
- A Journey Through the Deepfake Landscape: Unmasking Threats and Building Defenses, *IACP Technology Conference and Canadian Institute's Police Tech Conference*
- Building a More Explainable Analyst-Centered Deepfake Detection Tool, *Laboratory for Analytic Sciences (LAS) Research Symposium*
- 2023 DeFake: Developing a usable tool for deepfake awareness and identification, *Human Computer Interaction Consortium (HCIC)*

Professional Activities

2025	Reviewer , ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
	Reviewer , International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM)
	Poster Jury , Usable Security and Privacy (SOUPS)
2024	Reviewer , ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
	Reviewer , International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM)
2023	Reviewer , ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
	Poster Jury , Usable Security and Privacy (SOUPS)
2021	Internet Arrangements Committee , Privacy Enhancing Technologies (PETs)
	Organizing Committee , Great Lakes Security (GLSD)

Skills

Research	Qualitative user studies, Usability testing, A/B testing & data analysis, Survey design & analysis, Prototyping, ReVISit
Technical	<i>Programming</i> Python, JavaScript, HTML, Sass, SQL, C++, Java, Elixir <i>AI Tools</i> Cursor, Gemini Code, Github Copilot <i>Machine Learning</i> PyTorch, Keras, TensorFlow, Lightning <i>Web Development</i> ReactJS, NextJS, ExpressJS, Flask, FeathersJS, Docker
Design	UX design (wireframing, information flow, interaction design), Responsive UI design, Prototyping (Figma, Moqups, Balsamiq), Visual communication (Adobe Creative Suite)
Other	Project management, Team leadership & mentorship, Academic writing & research publication, Workshop/panel presentations
Languages	English (fluent), Russian (fluent), Bengali (fluent), Ukrainian (intermediate), Hindi (intermediate)

Certifications

2024	Generative AI with Diffusion Models , <i>NVIDIA</i>
	Building Transformer-Based Natural Language Processing Applications , <i>NVIDIA</i>
	Building Conversational AI Applications , <i>NVIDIA</i>
2023	Advanced Digital Investigations , <i>Knight Center for Journalism in the Americas</i>
	Social and Behavioral Research , <i>CITI Program</i>

Memberships

- Scientific Working Group on Digital Evidence (SWGDE)
- ARVA: AI Risk and Vulnerability Alliance
- ACM
- IEEE Biometrics Council
- Content Authenticity Initiative